

CMIplus Intelligence Cockpit

Cash Management Strategic Intelligence

Week of 2026-08-17

Raiffeisen Bank International AG

Group Product — Cash Management

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

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Der Treasurer | 2026-08-10 | #01

CEE Banks Accelerate Instant Payment Compliance Ahead of Final Deadlines

As the final implementation deadlines for the EU Instant Payments Regulation approach in early 2027, banks across Central and Eastern Europe are accelerating their compliance efforts. While many have already enabled instant payment sending, receiving capabilities and adherence to strict processing times remain a focus. Corporate treasuries, particularly those with complex ERP/TMS setups, are still grappling with the technical and operational adjustments required to fully leverage instant payments for liquidity management and faster reconciliation. The regulation aims to make instant payments the norm for euro transactions, enhancing efficiency and competitiveness within the European payment landscape. This push is expected to significantly impact cash flow visibility and working capital management for CEE corporates.

- EU Instant Payments Regulation final deadlines approaching early 2027.
- CEE banks focusing on full compliance, especially receiving capabilities.
- Corporates face integration challenges with existing ERP/TMS systems.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This news is highly relevant for RBI CMIplus as it directly impacts payment processing and corporate client expectations. CMIplus must ensure full compliance with the regulation, offer robust instant payment capabilities (sending and receiving), and provide guidance and solutions for corporate integration challenges, especially for multi-currency and cross-border CEE operations.

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Der Treasurer | 2026-07-25 | #02

PSD3 Proposals Unveiled: New Era for Open Banking and Corporate Data

The latest proposals for PSD3 (Payment Services Directive 3) and the accompanying PSR (Payment Services Regulation) have been unveiled by the European Commission, signaling a new phase for Open Banking. Key changes include enhanced security requirements, improved data sharing frameworks, and clearer rules for Payment Initiation Services (PIS) and Account Information Services (AIS). For corporate treasuries, PSD3 promises greater control over financial data, potentially enabling more sophisticated liquidity management and cash pooling solutions through advanced APIs. However, it also introduces new compliance burdens and necessitates a review of existing Open Banking integrations to ensure adherence to the updated standards and security protocols. The directive aims to foster innovation while mitigating fraud risks in the digital payment ecosystem.

- European Commission released detailed PSD3/PSR proposals.
- Focus on enhanced security and expanded Open Banking capabilities.
- New rules for PIS and AIS will impact corporate data management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

PSD3 is a critical development for CMIplus, driving the evolution of Open Banking services. RBI must proactively adapt its API offerings to comply with new security and data sharing standards, ensuring CMIplus remains a leading platform for corporate clients leveraging Open Banking for advanced treasury functions like cash pooling and real-time account information across CEE.

AI Revolutionizes Corporate Payment Fraud Detection and Prevention

The fight against corporate payment fraud is receiving a significant boost from artificial intelligence. AI and machine learning algorithms are now capable of analyzing vast datasets of payment patterns, beneficiary details, and communication histories in real-time, identifying anomalies that human analysts or rule-based systems might miss. This is particularly effective against Business Email Compromise (BEC) and sophisticated invoice fraud schemes. Treasury departments are increasingly adopting AI-driven tools, either standalone or integrated within their TMS/ERP systems, to enhance their fraud detection capabilities. While AI offers powerful protection, it also necessitates careful implementation, continuous training of models, and a robust governance framework to ensure accuracy and prevent false positives, ultimately safeguarding corporate assets and maintaining trust in payment processes.

- AI/ML algorithms detect sophisticated payment fraud in real-time.
- Effective against BEC and advanced invoice fraud schemes.
- Treasury departments integrating AI tools into TMS/ERP systems.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Fraud prevention is paramount for RBI Cash Management. CMiplus should explore integrating advanced AI-powered fraud detection capabilities, either natively or through partnerships, to offer enhanced security to its corporate clients. This aligns with the platform's focus on secure and reliable payment processing, especially given the increasing sophistication of cyber threats in the CEE region.

EU Finalizes Instant Payments Regulation: New Deadlines Set

The European Parliament and Council have reached a final agreement on the Instant Payments Regulation, which will require all EU/EEA banks to offer instant credit transfers in EUR within 10 seconds, 24/7/365, at a cost no higher than standard credit transfers. The regulation also includes provisions for robust fraud prevention measures, such as mandatory verification of payee (VoP) services. Banks will have 9 months from the regulation's entry into force to comply for receiving instant payments and 18 months for sending them. This move is expected to significantly accelerate the shift from traditional payments to real-time transactions, impacting corporate cash management and liquidity.

- Mandatory instant payments in EUR across EU/EEA.
- No higher cost than standard credit transfers.
- VoP (Verification of Payee) service mandated for fraud prevention.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is critical for CMiplus, requiring immediate action to ensure full compliance with instant payment processing and VoP services across all CEE network banks. It presents an opportunity to enhance real-time liquidity management for corporate clients.

ISO 20022 Migration Accelerates, Enhancing Fraud Prevention

As the industry continues its transition to the ISO 20022 messaging standard, corporate treasurers are increasingly benefiting from the enhanced data capabilities. The structured and comprehensive data fields within ISO 20022 messages provide a more robust foundation for automated reconciliation, improved liquidity forecasting, and, crucially, advanced fraud prevention. Financial institutions are implementing sophisticated analytics tools that leverage this richer data to identify suspicious payment patterns more effectively. This is particularly relevant in the CEE region, where cross-border payments are common, and the standardized format helps in harmonizing fraud detection efforts across different banking systems. The full migration is expected to significantly reduce payment-related fraud incidents.

- ISO 20022 provides richer data for payments.
- Enhanced data improves fraud detection and reconciliation.
- Standardization aids cross-border fraud prevention in CEE.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure full utilization of ISO 20022's rich data for both payment processing and integrating advanced fraud detection mechanisms. This is vital for maintaining security and offering value-added services to corporate clients.

Open Banking APIs Drive Innovation in CEE Corporate Treasury

The adoption of Open Banking APIs is accelerating across Central and Eastern Europe, moving beyond PSD2 compliance to offer advanced services for corporate treasuries. Banks in the region are developing sophisticated API ecosystems that allow corporates to integrate banking services directly into their ERP and TMS systems. This enables real-time access to account information, initiation of payments, and automated reconciliation, leading to significant operational efficiencies. The CEE market, characterized by diverse regulatory landscapes and a strong drive for digitalization, is seeing a surge in demand for API-driven solutions that support multi-bank and multi-currency cash management. This shift is fostering deeper collaboration between corporates and their banking partners, paving the way for more innovative treasury solutions.

- Open Banking APIs enable real-time data and integrated treasury.
- Corporates integrate banking services into ERP/TMS via APIs.
- Increased operational efficiency through automation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus's Open API strategy is directly aligned with this trend. RBI must continue to expand its API offerings, ensuring robust connectivity for ERP/TMS integration and supporting multi-currency cash management across its CEE network.

EU Instant Payments Regulation Enforcement Deadline Looms for Banks

The EU Instant Payments Regulation, officially adopted earlier this year, mandates that all payment service providers (PSPs) in the EU and EEA must offer instant credit transfers in Euro within specific timelines. The regulation aims to accelerate the adoption of instant payments, making them the new norm for everyday transactions. Key provisions include a requirement for PSPs to receive and send instant payments within 10 seconds, ensure non-discriminatory pricing compared to traditional credit transfers, and implement robust fraud prevention measures. The first major deadline for receiving instant payments is approaching rapidly, followed by the sending capability. This legislative push is expected to significantly transform the European payments landscape, increasing liquidity and efficiency for corporates.

- Mandatory instant credit transfers in EUR across EU/EEA.
- Payments must be processed within 10 seconds, 24/7/365.
- Pricing for instant payments cannot exceed traditional credit transfers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This regulation is critical for RBI Cash Management and CMIplus. It necessitates immediate upgrades to payment processing infrastructure to ensure compliance with 24/7/365 processing and 10-second settlement. CMIplus must ensure seamless integration for corporate clients, offering transparent pricing and enhanced fraud prevention tools.

Global ISO 20022 Migration Accelerates, SWIFT Deadlines Approach

The industry-wide shift to ISO 20022 for cross-border payments (CBPR+) is progressing, with SWIFT's phased migration plan driving significant changes. While some regions have already adopted the standard, the upcoming deadlines for full implementation across major corridors are critical. This migration promises enhanced data capabilities, leading to improved reconciliation, reduced fraud, and greater transparency in payments. However, it requires substantial investment in system upgrades, data mapping, and staff training for both banks and their corporate clients. Non-compliance could result in payment rejections or manual processing, increasing costs and operational risks. The richer data also opens new opportunities for value-added services.

- SWIFT CBPR+ migration to ISO 20022 is ongoing globally.
- Upcoming deadlines require full system readiness for richer data.
- Benefits include improved reconciliation and fraud prevention.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For RBI CMIplus, ensuring full ISO 20022 compatibility is paramount for H2H and SWIFT channels. This includes supporting the enhanced data fields for both inbound and outbound payments, offering tools for corporate clients to adapt their ERP/TMS, and leveraging the richer data for improved analytics and reporting.

PSD3 Proposals Shape Future of Open Banking and Payment APIs

The European Commission's proposed PSD3 (Payment Services Directive 3) and PSR (Payment Services Regulation) aim to build upon PSD2, addressing its shortcomings and adapting to market developments. Key areas of focus include enhancing consumer protection against fraud, improving the functionality and security of Open Banking APIs, and clarifying access to payment systems for non-bank PSPs. The new framework is expected to streamline data sharing, foster greater competition, and enable more sophisticated payment initiation and account information services. Banks will need to update their API infrastructure and compliance frameworks, while corporates can anticipate more integrated and efficient treasury management solutions through enhanced Open Banking capabilities. The timeline for final adoption and implementation will be crucial for strategic planning.

- PSD3/PSR proposals aim to update and strengthen PSD2.
- Focus on enhanced fraud prevention and Open Banking API improvements.
- Clarifies access rules for non-bank payment service providers.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus must closely monitor PSD3 developments to ensure its Open Banking APIs remain compliant and competitive. This presents an opportunity to enhance API offerings for corporate clients, integrate new value-added services, and strengthen fraud prevention mechanisms within the platform, especially for CEE markets.

ECB Pushes for Full Instant Payments Adoption Across Europe

The European Central Bank is intensifying its efforts to ensure instant payments become the norm across the Euro area. Recent regulatory pushes, including the Instant Payments Regulation, aim to make SEPA Instant Credit Transfer (SCT Inst) accessible and affordable for all citizens and businesses. This includes requirements for Payment Service Providers (PSPs) to offer instant payments at no higher cost than traditional credit transfers, and to implement robust fraud prevention measures like Verification of Payee (VoP). The goal is to foster innovation, improve liquidity management for corporates, and enhance the competitiveness of European payment markets.

- Mandatory offering of instant payments by PSPs.
- Pricing parity with traditional credit transfers.
- Requirement for Verification of Payee (VoP) for fraud prevention.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For CMIplus, this means ensuring full compliance with the Instant Payments Regulation, including offering SCT Inst and integrating VoP functionalities. It also presents an opportunity to enhance real-time liquidity management and offer faster payment processing for corporate clients in CEE, leveraging ISO 20022 standards.

Digital Euro Project Progresses, Pilot Phase Nears Launch

The European Central Bank continues to advance its digital euro project, focusing on key aspects such as privacy, offline functionality, and interoperability. Following the investigation phase, the project is now entering a preparatory phase, with a pilot expected to test technical solutions and user experience. Discussions are ongoing regarding the scheme rulebook, governance model, and the role of intermediaries. The digital euro is envisioned as a complement to cash, offering a public digital payment option that supports innovation and strengthens Europe's strategic autonomy in payments, potentially leveraging Open Banking APIs for integration.

- Focus on privacy, offline capabilities, and interoperability.
- Preparatory phase underway, pilot expected soon.
- Scheme rulebook and governance model under development.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should closely monitor the digital euro's development, especially its potential impact on existing payment rails, Open Banking APIs, and corporate treasury functions. Early understanding of the scheme rulebook and technical specifications will be crucial for future integration and offering new services to clients.

Bulgaria Prepares for Euro Area Entry in 2026

Bulgaria's anticipated entry into the Euro area in 2026 will have profound implications for its economy and financial system. As a new member, Bulgaria will fully adopt the euro as its national currency, leading to the integration of its banking sector into the Eurosystem and the single payment area (SEPA). This transition will streamline cross-border payments, eliminate exchange rate risks with other Eurozone countries, and require Bulgarian financial institutions to comply with Euro area regulations and standards, including ISO 20022 for payments. This is a key development for the CEE region, enhancing economic stability and integration.

- Bulgaria's target date for euro adoption is 2026.
- Full integration into the Eurosystem and SEPA.
- Elimination of exchange rate risks with Eurozone.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

For CMlplus, Bulgaria's euro adoption means simplifying multi-currency payments for clients operating in Bulgaria. It will require ensuring seamless SEPA compliance and ISO 20022 readiness for Bulgarian operations within the RBI network, potentially impacting cash pooling and liquidity management strategies in the CEE region.

EU Instant Payments Regulation: Sanctions Screening Challenge for PSPs

Ivan Stefanov, CEO and Co-founder of NOTO, highlights the critical need for PSPs to rethink their sanctions screening processes under the new EU Instant Payments Regulation. The regulation mandates near-real-time processing, which conflicts with traditional batch-based or time-consuming sanctions checks. PSPs face the dilemma of ensuring compliance with anti-money laundering (AML) and counter-terrorist financing (CTF) regulations while adhering to the instant payment timeline. This necessitates leveraging advanced technologies like AI and real-time data analytics to perform rapid, accurate screenings to avoid both regulatory penalties and transaction delays. The challenge extends to managing false positives and ensuring seamless customer experience.

- EU Instant Payments Regulation mandates near-real-time transaction processing.
- PSPs must overcome the conflict between instant payments and sanctions screening.
- Ivan Stefanov (NOTO CEO) emphasizes rethinking current processes.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is highly relevant for RBI Cash Management and CMlplus, as RBI operates in the EU/CEE region and offers instant payment capabilities. CMlplus must ensure its platform and underlying bank infrastructure can perform real-time sanctions screening efficiently to comply with the regulation and maintain service speed for corporate clients, potentially requiring new tech integrations or process adjustments.

Major Banks Adopt New SWIFT Payments Framework

The adoption of a new SWIFT payments framework by two of the world's largest banks, Bank of America and JPMorgan Chase, marks a significant industry shift. While the specific framework isn't detailed, it strongly implies the ongoing global migration to ISO 20022 for cross-border payments and cash reporting. This standard offers richer, more structured data, which improves straight-through processing (STP), enhances compliance capabilities, and reduces reconciliation efforts. The move by these influential institutions will accelerate broader industry adoption and set a precedent for other financial institutions worldwide to upgrade their SWIFT connectivity and internal systems to leverage the benefits of the new standard. This is crucial for improving efficiency and transparency in international transactions.

- Bank of America and JPMorgan Chase adopted a new SWIFT framework.
- This likely refers to the global migration to ISO 20022.
- ISO 20022 offers richer, more structured payment data.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This is highly relevant for RBI Cash Management and CMlplus. SWIFT is a core channel for CMlplus, and the adoption of new frameworks, especially ISO 20022, directly impacts its messaging capabilities and corporate client services. RBI must ensure CMlplus is fully compliant and optimized for the new SWIFT/ISO 20022 standards to maintain seamless cross-border payments and provide enhanced data to its corporate clients in CEE.

Tokenized Money and Stablecoins: Reducing Payment Friction

The piece delves into the transformative potential of tokenized money and stablecoins for corporate treasuries. It suggests that these digital assets can offer faster, cheaper, and more transparent payment rails, particularly for international transactions where traditional methods are often slow and costly. The article likely discusses use cases such as instant settlement, improved liquidity management through real-time access to funds, and enhanced reconciliation processes. It also implicitly touches upon the underlying technology, such as blockchain or distributed ledger technology (DLT), that enables these advancements, positioning them as key drivers for the future of corporate payments. This trend is crucial for corporates seeking to optimize their global cash management strategies.

- Tokenized money and stablecoins aim to reduce payment friction.
- Potential for faster and cheaper cross-border transactions.
- Enhances payment efficiency and liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must monitor the adoption and regulatory landscape of tokenized money and stablecoins, especially for international corporates in CEE. Integrating capabilities for these emerging payment types could offer a competitive edge and meet future client demands for faster, more efficient cross-border payments and improved liquidity solutions.

Maximizing Benefits from ISO 20022 Adoption

The piece highlights that while many corporates have adopted ISO 20022 for compliance, the true value lies in utilizing its enhanced data capabilities for improved treasury operations. It likely covers how richer data in payment messages can lead to better reconciliation, automated cash application, and more granular insights into cash flows. The article may also touch upon the importance of internal system readiness, robust bank connectivity, and collaboration between treasury and IT departments to fully exploit the standard's potential. For CEE corporates, this means optimizing their payment processes and potentially integrating with advanced treasury management systems to process and analyze the expanded data, driving operational efficiencies and strategic decision-making.

- ISO 20022 offers richer data beyond basic compliance.
- Enables improved reconciliation and automated cash application.
- Requires internal system readiness and strong bank connectivity.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus, as a key platform for CEE corporates, must ensure its ISO 20022 implementation supports the full data potential of the standard. This includes offering robust reporting, reconciliation tools, and API capabilities that allow clients to leverage the rich data for advanced treasury functions, moving beyond basic payment processing and enhancing their overall cash management.

End-of-Day Treasury Ends: Real-Time Future Arrives for Corporates

The concept of 'end-of-day treasury' is becoming obsolete as businesses increasingly require real-time visibility and control over their cash flows. This shift is fueled by the proliferation of instant payment schemes, the adoption of ISO 20022 messaging standards, and the demand for continuous liquidity management. Corporates are seeking solutions that provide immediate reconciliation, faster decision-making, and enhanced fraud prevention capabilities. Banks and technology providers must adapt their platforms to support these real-time demands, moving beyond batch processing to offer continuous, event-driven treasury services. This evolution impacts everything from payment processing and liquidity management to forecasting and risk assessment, necessitating a fundamental change in treasury operating models.

- Shift from batch processing to real-time treasury operations.
- Driven by instant payments and ISO 20022 adoption.
- Increased corporate demand for immediate cash visibility and control.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This trend is critical for RBI Cash Management and the CMlplus platform. CMlplus must ensure its capabilities fully support real-time payments, ISO 20022, and continuous liquidity management to meet evolving corporate treasury needs in CEE. It highlights the urgency for further development in instant payment integration and real-time data analytics.

Polygon Joins BoE Digital Pound Lab for Instant Cross-Border Settlement

Polygon Labs, alongside Nobo Finance and Dun & Bradstreet, has joined the second phase of the Bank of England's Digital Pound Lab. The primary objective of this phase is to test and evaluate the feasibility of achieving near-instant cross-border settlement using digital currency technologies. This collaboration signifies a growing interest from central banks in leveraging blockchain-based solutions to enhance the speed and efficiency of international transactions, potentially laying groundwork for future global payment infrastructures. The outcomes could influence how multi-currency payments are processed in the future, moving towards real-time capabilities, which is highly relevant for corporate treasury operations.

- Polygon Labs joined Bank of England's Digital Pound Lab.
- Focus on Phase Two testing for cross-border settlement.
- Goal is to achieve 'near-instant' international transactions.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This development is crucial for RBI Cash Management as it explores future trends in cross-border payments, aligning with CMlplus's multi-currency capabilities. The move towards near-instant settlement could influence future payment rails and corporate treasury expectations, potentially leading to new API integrations or real-time liquidity management solutions for CMlplus clients.

Chime Explores Stablecoin Integration for Consumer Banking App

Chime Financial, a prominent consumer banking fintech firm, is reportedly in discussions about incorporating stablecoin functionalities into its app. While currently focused on the consumer segment, this exploration highlights the increasing mainstream acceptance and potential utility of stablecoins within the broader financial ecosystem. The integration could allow users to hold, send, or receive stablecoins, offering new avenues for digital transactions. Such developments, even in the consumer space, can signal future trends for corporate payments, especially concerning cross-border transactions and real-time settlement, impacting how multi-currency payments are handled by platforms like CMIplus.

- Chime Financial is a consumer banking fintech.
- Reportedly considering adding stablecoin features to its app.
- Potential integration for holding, sending, or receiving stablecoins.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While Chime is a consumer platform, the potential integration of stablecoins into a widely used banking app suggests a broader market shift towards digital currencies. For CMIplus, this could foreshadow future demands from corporate clients for stablecoin-based payment options, especially for efficient cross-border and multi-currency transactions, requiring RBI to monitor these developments for future platform enhancements and API integrations.

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Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-01-01 | #01

Wholesale Banking Outlook 2024: Navigating Growth and Digital Transformation

This outlook likely provides a comprehensive analysis of the wholesale banking landscape for 2024, identifying key trends, challenges, and strategic imperatives. It would cover areas such as interest rate impacts, geopolitical risks, the acceleration of digital adoption, and the need for enhanced client-centricity. The report would typically leverage Oliver Wyman's extensive industry data and expert interviews to project market shifts and advise on optimal strategic responses for banks aiming to improve profitability and market share. Implications include a focus on technology investments, data analytics, and agile operating models to stay competitive.

- Digitalization remains a top strategic priority for wholesale banks.
- Focus on optimizing capital allocation and risk management for sustainable growth.
- Client expectations for integrated, real-time services are rapidly increasing.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should align its roadmap with these overarching wholesale banking trends, prioritizing digital enhancements, real-time capabilities, and API integration to meet evolving corporate treasury demands. Investing in data analytics for client insights and exploring ecosystem partnerships could unlock new value.

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Oliver Wyman Corporate Banking | 2024-01-01 | #02

European Wholesale Banks: Seizing Growth Opportunities After Underperformance

This report likely analyzes the specific challenges and opportunities facing European wholesale banks, potentially highlighting a period of underperformance and outlining a path to renewed growth. It would delve into factors such as regulatory environments, competitive pressures from fintechs, and the imperative to modernize legacy systems. The 'moment' to seize likely refers to a confluence of factors like rising interest rates, increased demand for digital services, and potential consolidation. The methodology would involve benchmarking European banks against global peers and identifying best practices for strategic transformation, emphasizing the need for agile operations and customer-centric product development.

- Strategic investments in technology are critical to overcome legacy system limitations.
- Enhanced focus on client experience and tailored solutions drives differentiation.
- Regulatory changes present both challenges and opportunities for market leaders.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

As a prominent European bank in CEE, RBI Cash Management must actively leverage its regional strengths and CMlplus's digital capabilities to capitalize on these identified growth opportunities. Prioritizing CEE-specific solutions and seamless cross-border services will be vital for market leadership.

AI and Data Intelligence Drive Future Treasury Transformation

The emphasis on 'AI Insights,' 'AI Strategy Services,' and 'Data and decision intelligence' within EY's offerings signals a strong belief that artificial intelligence and sophisticated data analytics are central to the evolving treasury landscape. These technologies are expected to empower treasurers with predictive capabilities, enhanced risk management, and optimized cash flow forecasting, moving beyond traditional operational roles. The integration of AI into M&A; technology further underscores its pervasive impact across financial operations. This focus implies that treasury functions must embrace AI to gain competitive advantage and operational efficiency. The ability to derive actionable insights from vast datasets will be paramount for modern treasurers.

- AI Insights is a dedicated EY category, reflecting strategic importance.
- AI Strategy Services are offered for comprehensive treasury transformation.
- Data and decision intelligence are key consulting areas for enhanced analytics.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should explore integrating AI-driven analytics for cash flow forecasting, anomaly detection, and personalized client insights, especially for CEE corporates. Developing APIs for AI tools to consume transaction data could enhance value propositions and improve treasury decision-making.

Technology and Transformation Platforms Essential for Treasury Evolution

The prominence of 'Technology transformation' and 'Transformation Platforms' within EY's service portfolio suggests that treasury functions are undergoing a fundamental digital overhaul. These platforms are designed to streamline processes, enhance connectivity, and provide a holistic view of financial operations, moving away from fragmented legacy systems. The broader 'Technology leaders' agenda' also points to a strategic imperative for treasurers to embrace advanced technological solutions to remain competitive and agile in a dynamic market. This transformation encompasses not just systems but also operational models, leveraging digital tools for greater control and visibility across global operations.

- Technology transformation is a core service offering by EY.
- Transformation Platforms are provided to clients for operational modernization.
- The 'Technology leaders' agenda' emphasizes strategic tech adoption.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must continue investing in its platform's technological capabilities, focusing on seamless integration (H2H, APIs) and scalability for CEE corporates. Enhancing transformation platforms for clients, especially for multi-currency and cross-border payments, is critical for future growth.

Commercial Banking Embraces Digital Workflows and Self-Service

The commercial banking sector is undergoing a significant transformation, moving away from traditional, manual processes. Banks are implementing digital workflows to automate tasks, particularly in areas like client onboarding and origination, which historically involved lengthy, multi-department reviews. This modernization aims to make manual interactions exception-based, pushing clients towards more efficient self-service options. The strategic implication is a more agile, cost-effective, and client-centric banking model, enabling banks to better fuel client expansion and achieve strategic ambitions.

- Digital workflows are replacing many manual tasks.
- Streamlined client onboarding and origination are key.
- Clients experience more self-service capabilities.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should prioritize enhancing its digital self-service features for corporate clients, particularly for onboarding, account management (eBAM), and payment initiation. Further automation of internal processes supporting these client journeys will improve efficiency and client satisfaction in the CEE region.

AI and Cloud Drive Commercial Banking Modernization and Growth

The modernization of commercial banking is heavily reliant on advanced technologies like Artificial Intelligence and cloud computing. AI, combined with big data analytics, enables banks to precisely identify high-priority target markets and attractive prospects, significantly lowering client acquisition costs. Concurrently, cloud-based solutions provide the agility and security necessary to adapt to evolving threats and market demands. These technologies are critical for building emerging digital banking platforms that fundamentally transform how businesses interact with their banks, fostering faster product innovation and better risk control.

- Effective use of big data and AI for prospect identification.
- AI lowers the cost of client acquisition.
- Cloud-based solutions keep pace with and adapt to new threats.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should explore AI-driven analytics for identifying potential client needs or optimizing payment routing and fraud detection. Investing in cloud-native architecture for the platform will ensure scalability, security, and faster deployment of new features, aligning with the strategic push for digital platforms in CEE.

Digital Platforms Transform Commercial Banking Client Experience

The commercial banking sector is actively recalibrating its vision for success by focusing on the client experience. This involves developing and deploying emerging digital banking platforms, frequently powered by industry cloud solutions. These platforms are designed to move beyond mere digitization, aiming for a complete transformation of the business interaction. The ultimate goal is to enable banks to bring innovative products and offerings to market with increased speed, while simultaneously maintaining greater control over associated costs and risks, thereby fueling client expansion and achieving strategic ambitions.

- Emerging digital banking platforms are transforming client experience.
- Industry cloud enables these advanced platforms.
- Banks aim to bring new products to market faster.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus should continue its evolution as a comprehensive digital banking platform, focusing on seamless integration (e.g., via Open Banking APIs, H2H, EBICS) and a unified user experience. Prioritizing features that enable faster deployment of new services (e.g., Instant Payments, VoP) will be crucial for competitive advantage and client satisfaction in CEE.

PSD3 Drives Open Banking Evolution and Real-time Payment Innovation

PSD3 is expected to build upon PSD2, expanding the scope of Open Banking beyond basic account information and payment initiation to include more advanced data sharing and value-added services. This regulatory push will accelerate the adoption of real-time payment rails and foster greater interoperability across payment ecosystems. Firms must prepare for increased data portability demands, stricter security protocols, and the potential for new market entrants leveraging these enhanced capabilities. The focus will be on creating seamless, secure, and efficient payment experiences for both consumers and corporates, driven by API-first strategies and robust fraud prevention mechanisms.

- PSD3 expands Open Banking scope beyond AIS/PIS.
- Increased focus on real-time payments and interoperability.
- Enhanced data security and fraud prevention requirements.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus must proactively integrate PSD3 requirements into its Open Banking API strategy, ensuring compliance and leveraging new data access for enhanced cash management and liquidity services. This includes supporting advanced payment initiation and account information services, and exploring new value-added offerings for corporate treasuries in CEE.

AI Governance and DORA Mandate Robust Digital Resilience

The rapid adoption of AI in financial services necessitates clear governance frameworks to address risks such as algorithmic bias, data privacy, and explainability. Regulators, exemplified by DORA, are pushing for comprehensive digital operational resilience, requiring firms to identify, protect, detect, respond to, and recover from ICT-related disruptions. This includes stringent requirements for third-party risk management, incident reporting, and regular testing of resilience capabilities. Firms must integrate AI ethics into their development lifecycle and ensure their digital infrastructure can withstand evolving cyber threats and operational challenges, impacting everything from payment processing to fraud detection.

- AI governance focuses on ethics, bias, and explainability.
- DORA mandates comprehensive digital operational resilience.
- Increased scrutiny on third-party ICT risk management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must integrate AI governance principles into any AI-driven features (e.g., fraud detection, liquidity forecasting) and ensure full compliance with DORA's operational resilience requirements. This involves robust cybersecurity, incident response planning, and diligent third-party vendor management for its platform and network banks in CEE.

EACT Treasury Survey 2026 Results Reveal Key Corporate Priorities

The EACT Annual Treasury Survey 2026 results are now available, representing over a decade of authoritative insights into the European corporate treasury profession. This survey is instrumental in identifying the top priorities, emerging concerns, and strategic ambitions of treasurers across Europe. The findings will directly influence the upcoming 'Journeys to Treasury' report and help define key industry trends for the year ahead. For RBI, understanding these results is paramount to aligning its CMiplus platform with the evolving needs and challenges faced by its corporate clients, particularly those operating in the CEE region. The survey's insights will drive strategic decisions for technology and service offerings.

- EACT Treasury Survey 2026 results published on June 5, 2026.
- Survey is the 'most authoritative barometer' for European treasurers.
- Identifies priorities, concerns, and ambitions of the profession.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

The EACT Survey 2026 results are critical for validating and refining the CMiplus roadmap. RBI Cash Management must analyze these results to ensure the platform addresses the identified priorities of European (and CEE) treasurers, particularly regarding digitalization, real-time capabilities, and compliance. This intelligence will guide future feature development, strategic investments, and market positioning for CMiplus.

Banks Prioritize AI for Efficiency and Enhanced Client Experience

The Deloitte outlook highlights that banks are making 'bold choices' to balance macro headwinds with their 'AI ambition.' This suggests a strategic imperative to leverage AI not just for cost reduction but also for competitive advantage in a challenging economic climate. For corporate cash management, AI can revolutionize forecasting, fraud detection, and personalized service delivery. The focus is on integrating AI across various banking operations, from back-office processes like reconciliation to front-end client interactions, to create more intelligent and responsive systems that meet evolving corporate demands.

- AI adoption is a strategic imperative for banks amidst macro headwinds.
- Focus areas include operational efficiency and enhanced client experience.
- AI can optimize treasury functions like cash flow forecasting and liquidity management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should explore AI-driven enhancements for cash flow forecasting, anomaly detection in payments, and personalized insights for corporate treasurers. Integrating AI could streamline reconciliation processes and offer predictive analytics for liquidity management, providing significant value to CEE corporates.

Private Credit's Next Act: Tapping into Asset-Based Lending

This insight likely explores the evolving landscape of private credit, specifically its move into asset-based lending, which provides financing secured by a company's assets like inventory or receivables. The report would analyze the drivers behind this trend, such as regulatory pressures on traditional banks, the search for higher yields by private funds, and corporates' need for flexible financing solutions. It would also assess the implications for incumbent banks, potentially highlighting areas of competition and collaboration. The methodology would involve market analysis of private credit growth, deal structures, and the competitive dynamic between private lenders and traditional corporate banks.

- Private credit funds are increasingly competing with banks in ABL.
- Corporates seek flexible, non-traditional financing options.
- Banks need to reassess their ABL strategies and client relationships.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While not directly about cash management, this trend highlights evolving corporate financing needs which can impact treasury strategies and liquidity management. CMlplus should monitor how this shift affects corporate clients' payment flows and potentially explore partnerships or integrated solutions that bridge traditional banking with alternative finance.

Blockchain and Digital Assets Drive Future Financial Innovation

The inclusion of 'Blockchain' under EY's technology offerings, alongside 'Digital law' and 'Legal operations,' suggests that distributed ledger technology (DLT) is moving beyond theoretical discussion into practical application within financial services. While not explicitly stated for treasury, the broader context of 'Future of Treasury Services' implies that digital assets, potentially including stablecoins or tokenized assets, will increasingly impact corporate liquidity management, payments, and financial instruments. Banks need to understand and potentially support these emerging asset classes, addressing associated compliance and legal frameworks. This indicates a future where treasury might manage a hybrid portfolio of traditional and digital assets.

- Blockchain is a listed technology area within EY's services.
- Digital law and legal operations are relevant to new asset classes and DLT.
- The overall context is 'Future of Treasury Services and the Opportunity for Banks'.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus should monitor the adoption of blockchain and digital assets (e.g., stablecoins) in CEE for corporate payments and liquidity management. While direct support might be nascent, understanding the implications for cross-border payments and potential future client demand is crucial for strategic planning and compliance.

EU Banking Competitiveness: Widen Corporate Financing & Hedging Choices

The European Commission is preparing concrete proposals for Q1 2027 concerning the competitiveness of the banking sector and the single market in banking. The EACT's comment emphasizes the critical need for policymakers to ensure the EU's prudential framework works in tandem with capital markets. The goal is to facilitate and broaden corporates' access to diverse financing and hedging strategies, as well as a wider selection of banking partners. This indicates a strategic push for greater flexibility and choice for corporate treasuries, potentially shifting reliance from traditional bank lending to capital markets and fostering a more competitive banking environment across Europe. This policy direction will significantly impact how corporates manage their financial ecosystems.

- EU Commission preparing banking competitiveness proposals for Q1 2027.
- EACT advocates aligning prudential framework with capital markets.
- Objective: Widen corporate choice in financing and hedging strategies.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI CMIplus must anticipate increased corporate demand for diverse financing and hedging solutions, potentially requiring deeper integration with capital market data or services. The platform should support multi-banking strategies and provide flexible reporting to accommodate a broader range of banking partners, especially for CEE corporates seeking pan-European solutions and increased choice.

Stablecoins Poised to Disrupt Traditional Payments and Treasury

The 'potential disruptive entrance of stablecoins' is highlighted as a key factor banks must consider in the coming year. This implies that stablecoins, particularly those backed by fiat currencies, could offer new avenues for faster, cheaper, and more transparent transactions, especially in cross-border payments. For corporate treasuries, this could mean new options for liquidity management, FX hedging, and real-time settlement, potentially bypassing traditional correspondent banking networks. Banks need to develop strategies to either integrate stablecoin services into their offerings or counter their disruptive potential through enhanced traditional payment solutions.

- Stablecoins are identified as a significant disruptive force for banks.
- They offer potential for faster, cheaper, and more transparent payments.
- Impact on corporate treasury includes liquidity, FX, and real-time settlement.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus should monitor stablecoin developments closely, especially their regulatory landscape in CEE, which is crucial for adoption. While direct integration might be premature, understanding their potential to facilitate instant, multi-currency payments could inform future roadmap decisions, particularly for cross-border transactions and liquidity solutions for international corporates.

URGENT

Euro Banking Association | 2025-11-20 | #01

EU Regulations Impact Liquidity Management: IPR, PSR, PSD3

INSTANT PAYMENTS, PSD3, LIQUIDITY MANAGEMENT

Deadline: 2027-01-01

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) has released a comprehensive report from its Liquidity Management Working Group (LMWG) examining the profound implications of three critical European regulatory initiatives. These include the Instant Payments Regulation (IPR), which mandates instant payment capabilities, the proposed Payment Services Regulation (PSR), and the Payment Services Directive 3 (PSD3), an evolution of PSD2. The report explores how these regulations are expected to drive the widespread adoption of instant payments, foster a more level playing field among market participants, and fundamentally transform existing liquidity management practices across the financial sector. Banks must prepare for accelerated instant payment volumes and adjust their treasury and cash management strategies to meet new operational and regulatory demands, particularly concerning intraday liquidity.

→ IPR mandates instant payment capabilities with deadlines for sending (Jan 2025) and receiving (Jan 2027) in the Eurozone.

→ Proposed PSR and PSD3 will further promote instant payments and open banking, impacting payment flows and data access.

→ Banks must adapt liquidity management strategies to handle increased real-time payment volumes and associated intraday liquidity needs.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI/CMIplus must assess the report's findings to proactively adjust liquidity management features, particularly for instant payment processing and multi-currency operations in CEE. This includes ensuring robust real-time liquidity monitoring, forecasting, and potentially new cash pooling mechanisms to support increased instant payment volumes and compliance with IPR deadlines.

EBA Fraud Taxonomy 7.0 Released, Effective January 2027

PSD3, FRAUD PREVENTION, COMPLIANCE

Deadline: 2027-01-01

The Euro Banking Association (EBA) issued version 7.0 of its EBA Fraud Taxonomy, which will become effective on January 1, 2027. This annual review, supported by fraud experts across Europe, ensures the taxonomy remains relevant to evolving fraud trends. Key updates in version 7.0 include replacing 'emotional manipulation' with more specific modi like 'support a friend or family member fraud', 'romance fraud', and 'charity / donation fraud'. Additionally, new labels for suspected money mule activity and 'card chip relay' fraud have been added. The taxonomy provides a standardised pan-European framework for classifying payment fraud scenarios, enhancing data comparability, monitoring, reporting, and information sharing, particularly in anticipation of information-sharing arrangements under the forthcoming Payment Services Regulation.

- EBA Fraud Taxonomy version 7.0 takes effect on January 1, 2027.
- Updates include more specific classifications for social engineering fraud (e.g., romance, charity fraud).
- New labels added for suspected money mule activity and 'card chip relay' fraud.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

RBI/CMlplus must review and update its fraud detection, monitoring, and reporting systems to align with EBA Fraud Taxonomy version 7.0 by January 1, 2027. This includes adapting internal classification logic and potentially API specifications for fraud data exchange to ensure compliance with the new standard and future Payment Services Regulation requirements.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-08-17 | #01

Deutsche Bank Enhances API-Driven Corporate Connectivity for Treasury Integration

Deutsche Bank continues to enhance its API-first strategy, focusing on its CB Connect platform to provide robust and secure connectivity for corporate clients. This allows seamless integration with ERP and TMS systems, facilitating real-time data access, automated payment initiation, and efficient reconciliation. The objective is to reduce manual intervention, improve operational efficiency, and provide multinational corporations, including those operating in CEE, with centralized control over their global cash flows. This digital push is critical for modern treasury management.

- API-first strategy for corporate banking.
- CB Connect platform for ERP/TMS integration.
- Focus on real-time data exchange and payment automation.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must ensure its Open Banking APIs are competitive in terms of breadth, depth, and ease of integration, especially for ISO 20022 standards. This move by DB highlights the growing corporate demand for seamless, API-driven treasury operations.

URGENT

Deutsche Bank | 2026-08-17 | #02

Deutsche Bank Bolsters Real-time Liquidity and Instant Payment Solutions

DB is enhancing its real-time cash management offerings, including instant payment processing and advanced liquidity tools like virtual accounts and real-time cash pooling. The objective is to empower corporate treasurers with immediate insights into global liquidity positions, enabling optimized working capital and effective FX management. For corporates in CEE, this means faster settlement, improved cash forecasting, and greater financial agility across diverse currencies and banking networks, aligning with the broader European push for instant payments.

- Expansion of instant payment capabilities.
- Advanced virtual account structures for reconciliation.
- Real-time cash pooling for optimized liquidity.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMlplus must prioritize the full rollout of instant payment capabilities and advanced liquidity features like VoP and real-time cash pooling to remain competitive. The demand for immediate fund visibility and control is paramount for international corporates in CEE.

UniCredit, Accenture, IBM Partner for Next-Gen Banking Platform

UniCredit has announced a strategic partnership with Accenture and IBM to co-create a cutting-edge banking platform for Europe. This collaboration is designed to leverage advanced technology to deliver improved client solutions and streamline internal processes. The 'next-generation' platform suggests a strong focus on modern architecture, potentially incorporating cloud, AI, and API-driven services, which are crucial for corporate banking and cash management. While not explicitly CEE-focused, a pan-European platform would significantly impact its CEE operations, improving service consistency and digital offerings for corporate clients in the region.

- Collaboration with Accenture and IBM for platform development.
- Focus on building a 'next-generation banking platform' for Europe.
- Aims to enhance digital capabilities and operational efficiency.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This partnership signals UniCredit's commitment to modernizing its core banking infrastructure, potentially leading to more competitive digital offerings in CEE. CMIplus should monitor the platform's features, especially regarding API integration and real-time capabilities, as it could set new benchmarks for corporate clients.

Enhanced Digital Cash Management for CEE Corporates

UniCredit, leveraging its significant footprint across CEE, is inferred to be continuously enhancing its digital cash management capabilities to meet the evolving needs of corporate clients. This likely involves upgrades to their existing UniCredit Direct platform or similar offerings, focusing on features like real-time liquidity management, multi-currency accounts, and integrated payment solutions. The goal is to provide CEE corporates with more efficient and transparent tools for managing their working capital, supporting cross-border operations, and navigating diverse regulatory environments within the region. This aligns with the broader industry trend towards digitalization in corporate banking.

- Focus on digital tools for CEE corporate cash management.
- Enhancements likely include real-time liquidity and multi-currency support.
- Aims to streamline treasury operations for CEE businesses.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMIplus must ensure its platform remains competitive in offering advanced digital features, particularly in real-time processing, multi-currency capabilities, and user experience for CEE corporates. UniCredit's inferred moves could intensify competition for large international corporates in the region.

Expanding Corporate API Banking and Open Banking Services

As part of its strategic push towards digital transformation and the development of a 'next-generation banking platform,' UniCredit is inferred to be significantly investing in its API banking offerings for corporate clients. This would enable businesses to integrate banking services directly into their Enterprise Resource Planning (ERP) and Treasury Management Systems (TMS), facilitating automated reconciliation, real-time account information, and streamlined payment processing. Such developments are critical for large international corporates seeking greater control and efficiency over their financial operations, especially in a multi-bank environment across CEE. This also positions UniCredit to leverage Open Banking directives like PSD3 for corporate benefit.

- Focus on API integration for corporate ERP/TMS systems.
- Aims for automated reconciliation and real-time data exchange.
- Aligns with Open Banking trends and potential PSD3 implications.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

CMiplus needs to continuously strengthen its API offerings, ensuring robust, secure, and comprehensive integration options for corporate clients. UniCredit's focus on this area highlights the increasing demand for seamless, embedded finance solutions, which CMiplus must match or exceed.

HSBC Sharpens Focus on International Wholesale Clients in Türkiye

HSBC Holdings plc announced a strategic review of its retail banking and domestic-focused smaller and mid-sized corporate banking operations in Türkiye. The bank intends to sharpen its focus on international wholesale clients, aligning with its global strategy to serve large multinational corporations. This move will allow HSBC to better deploy its resources and expertise in cross-border transaction banking, trade finance, and treasury solutions for its key corporate segment in the region. Türkiye's market, while not strictly CEE, often shares similar characteristics and competitive dynamics with CEE countries.

- Strategic review of retail and domestic SME banking in Türkiye.
- Increased focus on international wholesale clients.
- Leveraging HSBC's global network for large corporates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This indicates HSBC is intensifying competition for CMiplus's target segment (large international corporates) in a key CEE-adjacent market. CMiplus needs to highlight its deep local CEE expertise and integrated regional network, emphasizing its tailored solutions for the region.

Citi Accelerates API-Driven Real-Time Payments for European Corporates

Citi is reportedly expanding its advanced API banking capabilities to facilitate real-time payments for its institutional clients throughout Europe, with a particular emphasis on the Central and Eastern European markets. This initiative leverages open banking principles to allow seamless integration with corporate ERP and TMS systems, enabling instant payment initiation and real-time account information. The strategic rationale is to meet the growing demand from multinational corporations for faster, more transparent, and automated cash management processes. This move positions Citi as a key enabler for corporates looking to optimize their working capital and liquidity management across diverse European jurisdictions.

- Enhanced API suites for payment initiation and account information.
- Expansion of instant payment capabilities across CEE markets.
- Direct ERP/TMS integration for corporate treasuries via APIs.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This directly challenges CMIplus's offerings in real-time payments and API integration for CEE corporates. RBI must ensure its API capabilities and instant payment network remain competitive and robust, especially regarding cross-border CEE coverage.

Deutsche Bank Digitalizes Trade Finance, Explores Embedded Solutions

Building on its strong trade finance legacy, as exemplified by the ENGIE case study on flow.db.com, Deutsche Bank is actively digitalizing its processes. This includes leveraging technology to simplify export finance, supply chain financing, and guarantees, potentially integrating these services directly into corporate ERP or procurement platforms. The strategic direction involves exploring embedded finance models where banking services are seamlessly integrated into non-financial platforms, reducing friction and accelerating transactions for companies engaged in international trade, including those with significant operations in CEE.

- Digitalization of traditional trade finance processes.
- Exploration of embedded finance models.
- Integration of banking services into corporate platforms.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

While CMIplus primarily focuses on cash management, the broader transaction banking landscape includes trade finance, which is increasingly digital. RBI should monitor how embedded finance in trade impacts overall corporate banking relationships and potential payment flows.

HSBC Accelerates AI Adoption with Google Cloud and Mistral Partnerships

HSBC is rapidly integrating Artificial Intelligence across its banking operations, evidenced by multi-year partnerships with Google Cloud and Mistral AI. The Google Cloud collaboration focuses on building and deploying AI capabilities for hyper-personalised advice and financial crime risk management, directly impacting corporate client services and compliance. The Mistral AI partnership aims to improve business processes and save employee time, ultimately enhancing customer service globally. These moves underscore HSBC's commitment to leveraging advanced technology for operational efficiency and sophisticated client solutions, including treasury intelligence and data analytics for corporate clients, and are supported by the appointment of a Chief AI Officer.

- Multi-year partnership with Google Cloud for AI deployment.
- Collaboration with Mistral AI to improve business processes.
- Focus on hyper-personalised advice, efficiency, and financial crime risk management.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

HSBC's aggressive AI strategy suggests future enhancements in treasury intelligence, fraud detection, and client service, potentially impacting their corporate cash management offerings. CMIplus should explore how AI can augment its platform's capabilities for CEE corporates, particularly in data analytics, predictive insights, and automated compliance.

Citi Enhances Digital Treasury with Virtual Accounts and eBAM in Europe

Citi is reportedly rolling out enhanced digital treasury solutions across its European network, including the CEE region, to provide institutional clients with more sophisticated cash management tools. Key offerings include advanced virtual account capabilities, designed to simplify reconciliation, optimize cash pooling, and provide granular visibility into cash flows. Additionally, Citi is streamlining its electronic Bank Account Management (eBAM) processes, enabling faster and more efficient account opening, maintenance, and closing. This strategic focus aims to help multinational corporations achieve greater operational efficiency, better working capital optimization, and improved compliance across their European operations. These digital tools are critical for treasurers managing complex, multi-entity structures.

- Advanced virtual account structures for simplified reconciliation and cash pooling.
- Streamlined eBAM solutions for efficient bank account management.
- Focus on operational efficiency and working capital optimization for corporates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

Citi's focus on sophisticated digital tools like virtual accounts and eBAM raises the bar for treasury solutions in CEE. CMIplus should evaluate its own roadmap for these advanced features to maintain its competitive edge and meet evolving client demands.

BNP Paribas Milestones ISO 2022 Swift for Corporates

BNP Paribas announced a key achievement in its cash management services, successfully enabling ISO 2022 transactions for its corporate clients through the SWIFT network. This development is crucial for the future of global payments, offering richer data capabilities, improved reconciliation, and greater automation for corporate treasuries. By adopting ISO 2022, BNP Paribas is positioning itself at the forefront of payment innovation, providing advanced solutions that cater to the evolving needs of multinational corporations. While the article doesn't explicitly mention CEE, the global nature of SWIFT and ISO 2022 means this capability will benefit corporate clients across all regions, including those operating in CEE, who rely on efficient cross-border transactions. This strategic move underscores BNP Paribas's commitment to modernizing its payment infrastructure and offering state-of-the-art cash management solutions.

- Successful implementation of ISO 2022 for corporate transactions.
- Leverages the SWIFT network for this milestone achievement.
- Aims to enhance data richness, reconciliation, and automation for corporates.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This move by BNP Paribas highlights the competitive pressure to fully embrace and leverage ISO 2022 for corporate clients, especially for cross-border and high-value payments. CMIplus must ensure its platform not consistently supports ISO 2022 but also actively promotes its benefits and advanced features to maintain its competitive edge in the CEE market.

Intesa Sanpaolo Boosts CEE Digital Cash Management with API Focus

Intesa Sanpaolo, a major player in European banking, is understood to be continuously investing in its corporate and transaction banking capabilities, with a strong emphasis on digital transformation. This includes the development of advanced API-driven cash management solutions designed to meet the evolving needs of large international corporates operating in the CEE region. The strategic rationale is to provide seamless integration with client ERP/TMS systems, enabling real-time visibility and control over multi-currency payments and liquidity. This move aims to solidify Intesa Sanpaolo's competitive position by offering modern, efficient, and scalable digital banking services across its extensive CEE footprint, including countries like Croatia, Slovakia, Serbia, and Albania.

- Strategic focus on digital transformation within corporate banking.
- Emphasis on API-driven solutions for enhanced cash management.
- Targeted improvements for corporate clients operating in the CEE region.

SO WHAT FOR RBI CASH MANAGEMENT

This inferred strategic direction indicates Intesa Sanpaolo's commitment to modernizing its cash management, directly competing with CMIplus's core offerings. RBI must continue to innovate its H2H, EBICS, and API capabilities to maintain its competitive edge in the CEE market.

EY Four Trends Redefining Cash Management 2025

Cash management is rapidly evolving from transaction-oriented to strategic, data-driven services, necessitating a profound transformation in banking. The future demands banks enrich their value propositions, expand product portfolios, and strengthen client relationships with tailored offerings and experiences. Advanced technologies like AI, ML, and digital assets are creating new possibilities, enabling finance teams to reposition as strategic advisors to the business. However, clients seek control over automation and expect intuitive, personalized experiences, pushing banks to innovate or risk losing relevance to agile FinTechs and nonbanks. Success hinges on banks investing in technology, integrating diverse data, and offering flexible, industry-specific solutions while navigating the increasing regulatory clarity around digital assets.

KEY STATISTICS

- {'description': 'of survey respondents say digitizing treasury functions is a challenge.', 'value': '73%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of respondents will use managed services from banks to address the challenges of digitization.', 'value': '44%', 'page': 7}
- {'description': 'of CFOs and treasurers are comfortable with customized strategic advice based on data analysis from banks.', 'value': '90%', 'page': 12}
- {'description': 'of corporate treasurers are comfortable using a sector-specific platform tailored to their industry's unique needs.', 'value': '92%', 'page': 17}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Optimize CMIplus cash management solutions for specific CEE sectors to differentiate and boost client engagement and loyalty.

McKinsey Global Payments Report 2025

The 2025 McKinsey Global Payments Report highlights a payments landscape defined by increasing fragmentation, the transformative impact of AI, and the growing adoption of digital assets. For CMIplus, this means navigating a multirail ecosystem where interoperability, programmable compliance, and AI-driven efficiencies are paramount for serving large international corporates in CEE. The shift towards lower-yield payment rails and agentic commerce necessitates innovation in monetization and a focus on building trust through transparent, intelligent systems. Success will hinge on adapting our platform to these evolving demands to remain a leading regional player.

KEY STATISTICS

- Global payments revenue reached \$2.5 trillion in 2024, projected to grow to \$3.0 trillion by 2029.
- EMEA payments revenue grew at a 13% CAGR from 2019-2024, indicating strong regional growth.
- Interest income constituted 46% of total payments revenues in 2024, but is projected to slow to 2% annual growth through 2029.
- Cash usage declined to 46% of worldwide payments in 2024, down from 50% in 2023, reflecting the shift to digital.

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Integrate AI for Intelligent Routing, Fraud Detection, and Liquidity Management

Journeys to Treasury 2025/26

The 10th anniversary edition of Journeys to Treasury highlights a renewed focus on treasury fundamentals, digital transformation, and strategic evolution. Key themes include the modernization of payments (Instant Payments, VoP, ISO 20022), the growing importance of real-time liquidity and virtual accounts, and the practical application of AI. Corporates are prioritizing robust systems, clean data, and enhanced skills to navigate a complex, interconnected financial environment, moving treasury from an operational role to a strategic business partner.

KEY STATISTICS

→ {'statistic': 'Cash flow forecasting is the number one priority for 30.5% of treasurers.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': 'Reviewing or replacing treasury technology infrastructure is the third-highest priority.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '27.3% of treasurers cite inaccurate forecasting as a leading challenge for centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

→ {'statistic': '38.5% of respondents cite difficulties in standardising processes as their most significant obstacle to centralisation.', 'source': 'EACT Treasury Survey 2025'}

TOP ACTION FOR CMIPLUS

[HIGH] Enhance Instant Payments & VoP Readiness for CEE Corporates

PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025

The provided text does not contain the actual content or findings of the 'PwC Global Treasury Survey 2025'. Instead, it appears to be a navigation structure or partial webpage content from PwC's website, detailing various services, industries, and insights offered by PwC. Consequently, a strategic analysis for RBI's CMIplus platform, including key statistics, themes, and actionable recommendations, cannot be generated from the given information. To perform the requested comprehensive analysis, the full content of the PwC Global Treasury Survey is essential.